effectiveness of the democratic process is only more apparent. This is no mean achievement, given the alienation caused by globalization and the disaffection fomented by disinformation. In our case, we are seeing an increased vigour of democratic activities and debates, supported by the validation of power transfers. And we can confidently state that unlike in some other places, at least our election results are not doubted! It can, in fact, truly be said that democracy is not just doing well but better than ever before.

In an argumentative society like India, political debates often take the form of polemics. A globalized existence means that they can even spill beyond our borders. But for those who see first-hand how consistently our people expand their freedoms, it is evident that India's value has grown in the eyes of the world because it is not only a political exercise at home but also a democratic assertion of a resurgent society.

When the virtues of an open society are being rediscovered, it is not enough to be a democracy. We have surely been one for 75 years in a narrow sense and, in truth, very much longer societally. It is even more important to be a democracy that delivers. It is on this score that the last decade has been so critical. A genuine passion for good governance, combined with effective application of technology tools, has started to transform the socio-economic landscape. And the world can only marvel at the scale and intensity of the transformation.

By firmly establishing a digital backbone across the country, 800 million plus Indians received food support and half of them also received money in their bank accounts during the Covid pandemic. Think about the enormity of this effort: it is like supporting the entire European and American populations at the same time. Indeed, each one of the programmes and schemes has been carried out on a magnitude that approximates the population of a major nation. The Jan Dhan initiative is like banking the US and Mexico at one go; the Saubhagya scheme is like electrifying all of Russia; Ujjwala is equivalent to changing the cooking fuel for all of Germany; and the Awas Yojana is like housing all of Japan. Examples could be cited in other areas like clean water, health coverage and farm support. The direct benefit transfers (DBTs) from India's digitalization have also ended a long tradition of leakages. The 2 billion plus vaccinations too are a feat in themselves. Perhaps the biggest lesson is how these initiatives have helped to democratize technology and empower the masses.